

ARCHITECTURAL PORTFOLIO

Hanibal Ravandeh

Architectural Designer | Residential Renovation, Extension & New-Build Design

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ABOUT

I work between ideas and evidence.

I am an Architectural Designer, focused on residential renovation, extension, and new-build design, with more than 13 years of experience working across architectural visualization, BIM, and design development.

My approach begins before the model.

I study the site, its constraints, its surroundings, and the conditions that can shape a project. Then I test ideas against those conditions rather than assuming that the first answer is the right one.

Idea ↔ Site

I don't see an architectural idea and its site as separate steps.

The site can challenge the idea.

The idea can reveal something new about the site.

That tension is where the work begins.

I develop alternatives seriously enough that each one can be judged on its own merits. Iteration is not about producing more options for the sake of it. It is about making the alternatives concrete enough to compare, test, and eventually defend a decision with evidence.

The principle behind this process is simple:

I trust the first idea enough to fight for it — but not enough to stop testing it.

How I Work

I use visualization and BIM not simply as production tools, but as ways of making architectural decisions visible.

My technical practice includes 3ds Max, V-Ray, Corona Renderer, AutoCAD, Revit, and Unreal Engine.

I also deliberately spent 15 months working hands-on within a Danish construction-site environment, using that experience to understand building culture and construction from closer to the physical reality of a project.

The goal is not to make an image look convincing while the underlying idea remains unresolved.

The goal is to make the architecture clear enough to question, compare, communicate, and ultimately build.

A project often moves through a cycle:

IDEA → SITE → TENSION → ITERATION → EVIDENCE → DECISION
→ REALIZATION → REFLECTION



RESIDENTIAL — VILLA RENOVATION

Villa Red Sun

Villa Red Sun merges two separate existing buildings into one coherent home, resolving a real conflict between cost-driven and quality-driven client priorities through seven tested design proposals.

Architectural Design, Visualization & BIM Documentation

3ds Max / V-Ray / Corona Renderer / AutoCAD / Revit

PROCESS

01 — CLIENT CHALLENGE

What did the client actually need, and why was it hard?

The client owned two separate residential buildings on the same property and wanted a single, functional home. The wife and husband held opposing priorities: the wife wanted to minimize demolition, construction work, and overall cost; the husband wanted the best possible architecture, without financial limitations.

02 — SITE

What was the physical starting condition?

Two independent structures shared a single plot, each with its own orientation, daylight condition, and relationship to the site. Any merging strategy first had to be tested against how each building already related to light, privacy, and access.

03 — CONSTRAINTS

What limits shaped every decision from here on?

Budget and ambition pulled in opposite directions from within the same household. Connecting two buildings into one circulation system, without knowing in advance which financial scenario the client would ultimately accept, meant the design had to remain legible across multiple cost tiers rather than committing early to one.

04 — DESIGN THINKING

How was the problem approached?

Rather than proposing a single solution, seven design proposals were developed across three cost/quality tiers — A (low cost, minimum demolition), B (medium cost), and C (high quality, higher intervention) — before a final, complete architectural revision (D) was developed as the highest-quality synthesis.

05 — FINAL DECISION

Why did this proposal win?

Proposal D was selected. It fully integrated both buildings into a single, cohesive residence. It required the highest investment, but delivered the greatest improvement in functionality, spatial quality, and architectural identity — the criteria that mattered most once both family members saw the alternatives side by side.

B-2

Medium cost



Master Plan



Circulation

C-1

High quality, higher intervention



Master Plan



Circulation

D — Selected

Highest quality, highest cost — complete architectural revision



Master Plan



Circulation

FINAL ARCHITECTURE — PLANS & SECTIONS



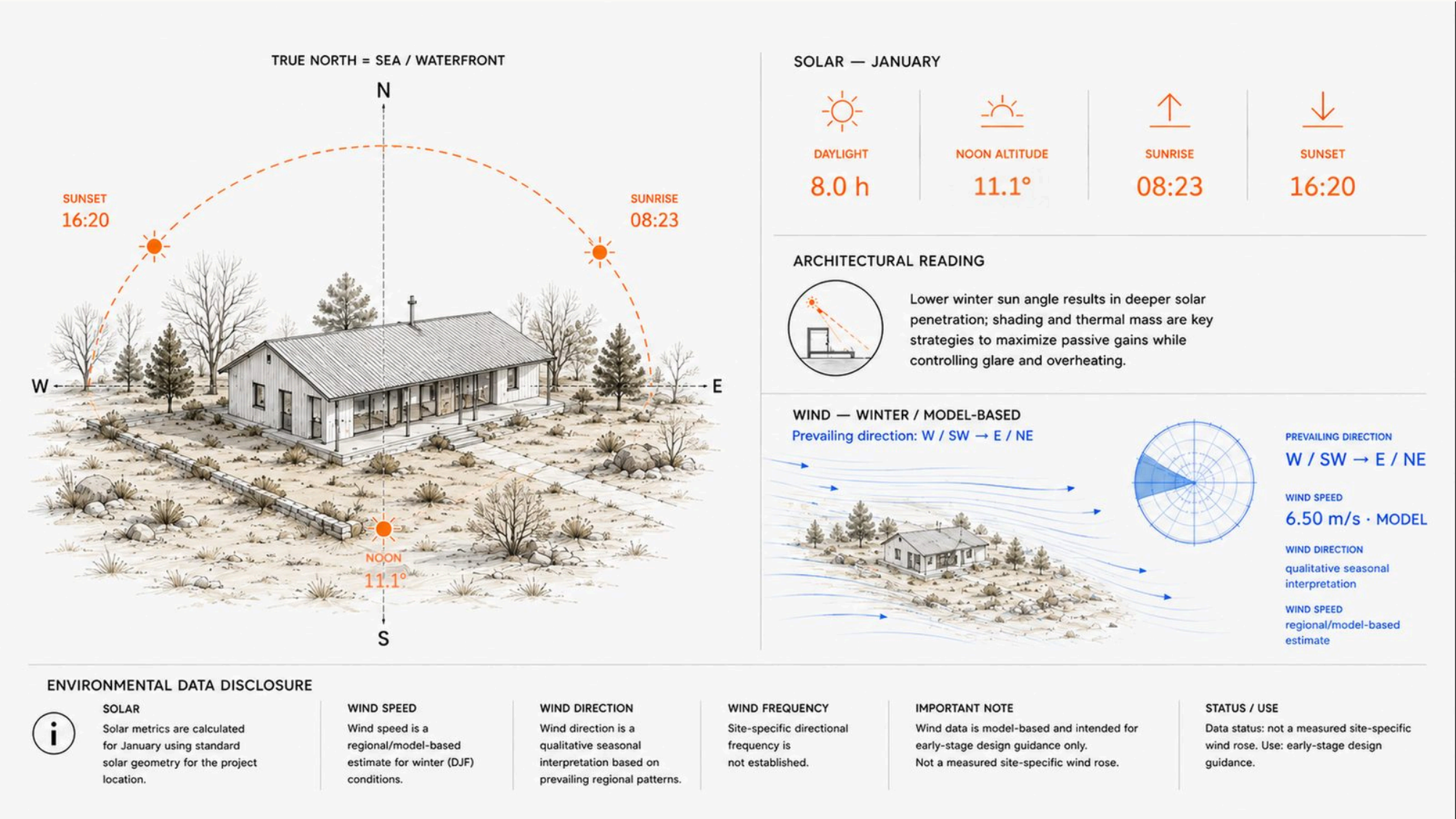
Illustrated floor plan — final proposal.



Section A-A — final proposal, illustrated.



Section B-B — final proposal, illustrated.

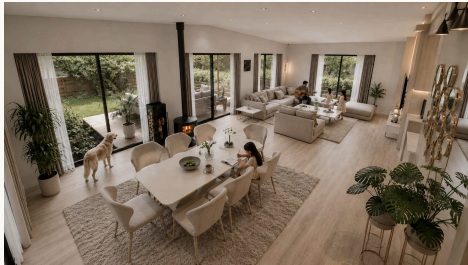




Exterior — View 03



Exterior — View 02



Interior — Dining Room



Interior — Kitchen



Interior — Master Bedroom

Villa Red Sun began as the conversion of two previously separate residential units into a single coherent house. From the outset the real difficulty was not the physical act of joining the buildings, but the fact that the two people I was designing for wanted fundamentally different things. The wife wanted the renovation kept as low-cost and logical as possible. The husband wanted a complete, ideal solution so that the technical problems they currently lived with would never return. One small but telling detail made the history of the house visible early on: one of the left-side units had already been partially renovated at a different time, and its parquet floor sat half a centimetre higher than the other — a physical trace of two homes that had never truly been one.

Both owners were concerned that relocating the bathrooms and kitchen would push the overall cost significantly higher because of the plumbing work involved. In the early schemes (groups A to C) the strategy was therefore to leave the two recently renovated bathrooms in the central core of the house as untouched as possible. After examining the construction documents I was able to show them that the foundation was of a special type with a void underneath, which meant the pipes could be relocated without the high cost everyone assumed. I promised that in the new design the bathrooms would remain as close as possible to the main sewer line so that costs would stay controlled. The roof was a separate fixed constraint — removing or altering it was considered prohibitively expensive — so we kept it in place. To connect the two units underneath without creating a cramped, tunnel-like corridor, I designed a series of bridges and steel columns that could carry the roof load while opening a much wider, uninterrupted span at the connection point.

Beyond the cost-versus-quality tension between the two owners, a practical problem came from the units' separate renovation histories. Doors and windows throughout the house were in different states, different sizes and different materials, each renovated independently on different budgets at different times. A limited intervention that simply removed one wall would have produced a larger space and satisfied some of the cost concerns, but the result would have been an awkward, tunnel-like unit — a real liability at resale. Weighed against the legal complexity of merging two separate deeds into one, only a proper and complete renovation — Proposal D — actually resolved what both units had accumulated over the years rather than compromising around it.

Looking back, I would not change how I ran the comparison process. I spent a great deal of time on it and brought the clients real documentation, especially the foundation evidence, rather than asking them to simply trust a costlier option. I still believe the principle: "I trust the first idea enough to fight for it — but not enough to stop testing it." Of the two houses in this portfolio, it is Villa Red Sun where that sentence applies most clearly. The idea survived because it was tested against real client resistance and real evidence, not because it went unquestioned.



RESIDENTIAL — COASTAL VILLA, NEW CONSTRUCTION

Villa Efe

Villa Efe is a ground-up luxury villa on a steep Mediterranean waterfront site in Northern Cyprus, organizing four privacy-graded levels — from a below-grade service basement to a rooftop leisure deck — around uninterrupted sea views, engineered coastal excavation, and a continuous indoor-outdoor living sequence.

Architectural Design, Visualization, Interior & Landscape Coordination

3ds Max / V-Ray / Corona Renderer / AutoCAD / Revit

PROCESS

01 — CLIENT CHALLENGE

What did the client need, and why did it require starting from scratch?

An outdated existing residence occupied the site, but the client's spatial requirements exceeded what that building could accommodate, making renovation impractical. The brief called for a contemporary luxury villa maximizing the site's sea views while providing complete privacy, generous family spaces, premium leisure facilities, and long-term functionality — with a clear split between public and private areas, independent staff accommodation, large parking capacity, and an indoor-outdoor living experience throughout.

02 — SITE

What was the physical starting condition?

The site is a rare waterfront plot directly at sea level with uninterrupted panoramic Mediterranean views, on land with a very steep natural slope that creates multiple access levels. Standing inside the villa facing the sea means facing true north; the opposite side of the site opens onto mountain and forest views. The same site also brought real constraints: extreme proximity to the sea, a high groundwater level, and significant level differences across the plot.

03 — CONSTRAINTS

What limits shaped every decision from here on?

Basement excavation this close to the sea required specialized engineering — soil retention systems and structural concrete techniques suited to coastal construction were built into the design from the earliest stage. Beyond the engineering, every level had to maximize sea views from its major living spaces while still preserving privacy, and the steep, groundwater-affected site had to absorb a full below-grade basement without compromising spatial clarity above it.

04 — DESIGN THINKING

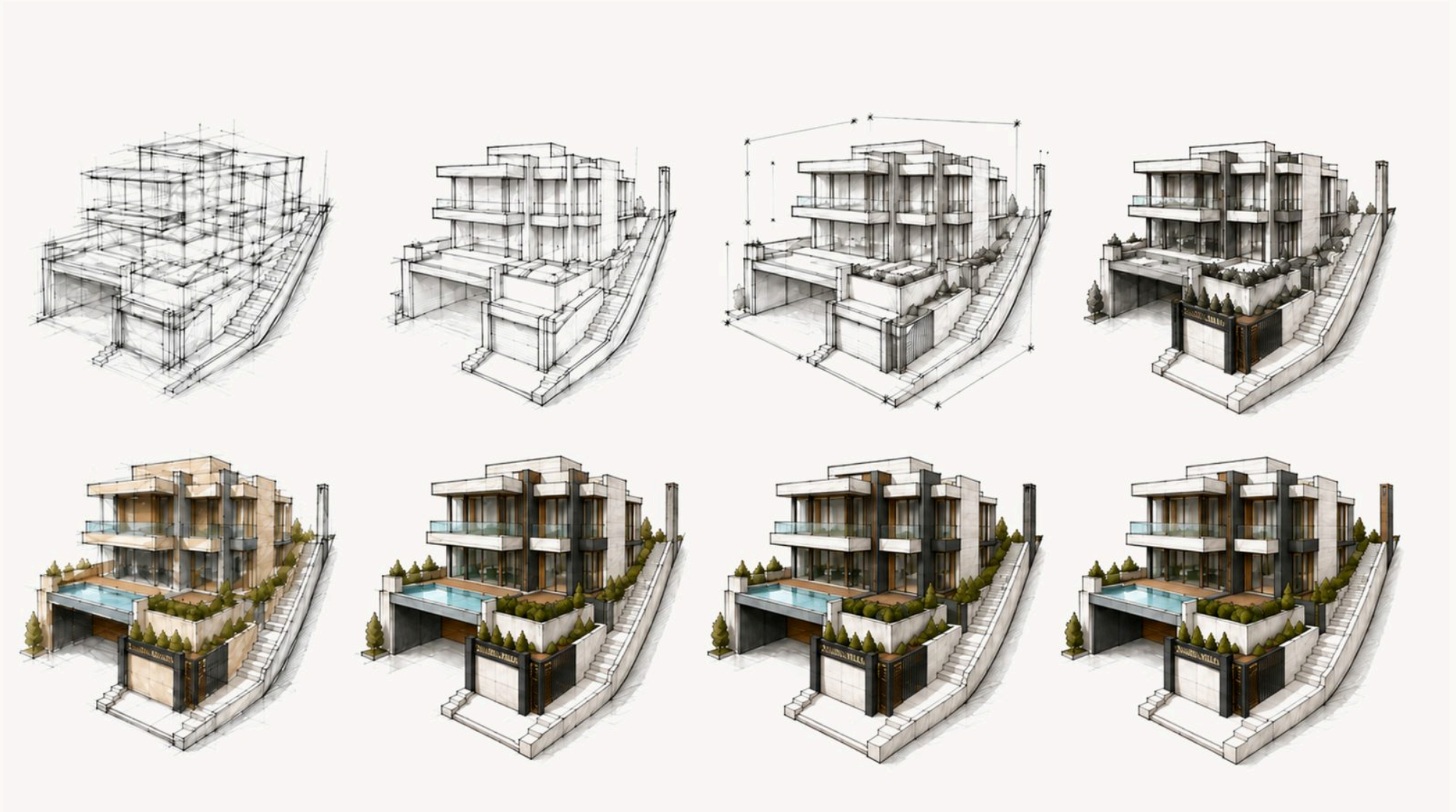
How was the problem approached?

Rather than a collection of isolated rooms, the villa was conceived as a sequence of interconnected living environments, with interior and exterior spaces continuously interacting through large openings, terraces, water features, and framed views. The building is organized vertically by privacy level — service and staff space in the basement, public family life on the ground floor, private bedrooms on the first floor, and leisure space on the roof — connected by a central stair and elevator, and lit throughout by a multi-story interior terrarium that carries daylight from the ground floor to the roof.

05 — FINAL DECISION

How did the final design come together?

The design evolved over roughly eight months through continuous collaboration between the design team and the homeowners, with regular meetings to evaluate every important decision before approval. The owners actively participated in space planning, interior layouts, room relationships, materials, color palettes, furniture concepts, and overall atmosphere, with multiple alternatives presented throughout the process before each final selection was made.



Design development — from early massing studies to final detailing.

DESIGN THINKING — VERTICAL PRIVACY HIERARCHY



Basement
Service, entertainment & staff accommodation



Ground Floor
Public family & social spaces



First Floor
Private bedrooms



Roof Terrace
Leisure & panoramic outdoor living

FINAL ARCHITECTURE — PLANS



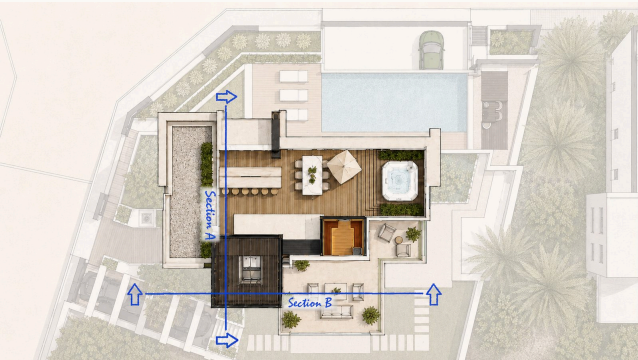
BASEMENT
Basement plan with section cut-lines.



GROUND FLOOR
Ground Floor plan with section cut-lines.



FIRST FLOOR
First Floor plan with section cut-lines.



ROOF TERRACE
Roof Terrace plan with section cut-lines.



SITE
Site plan with section cut-lines.

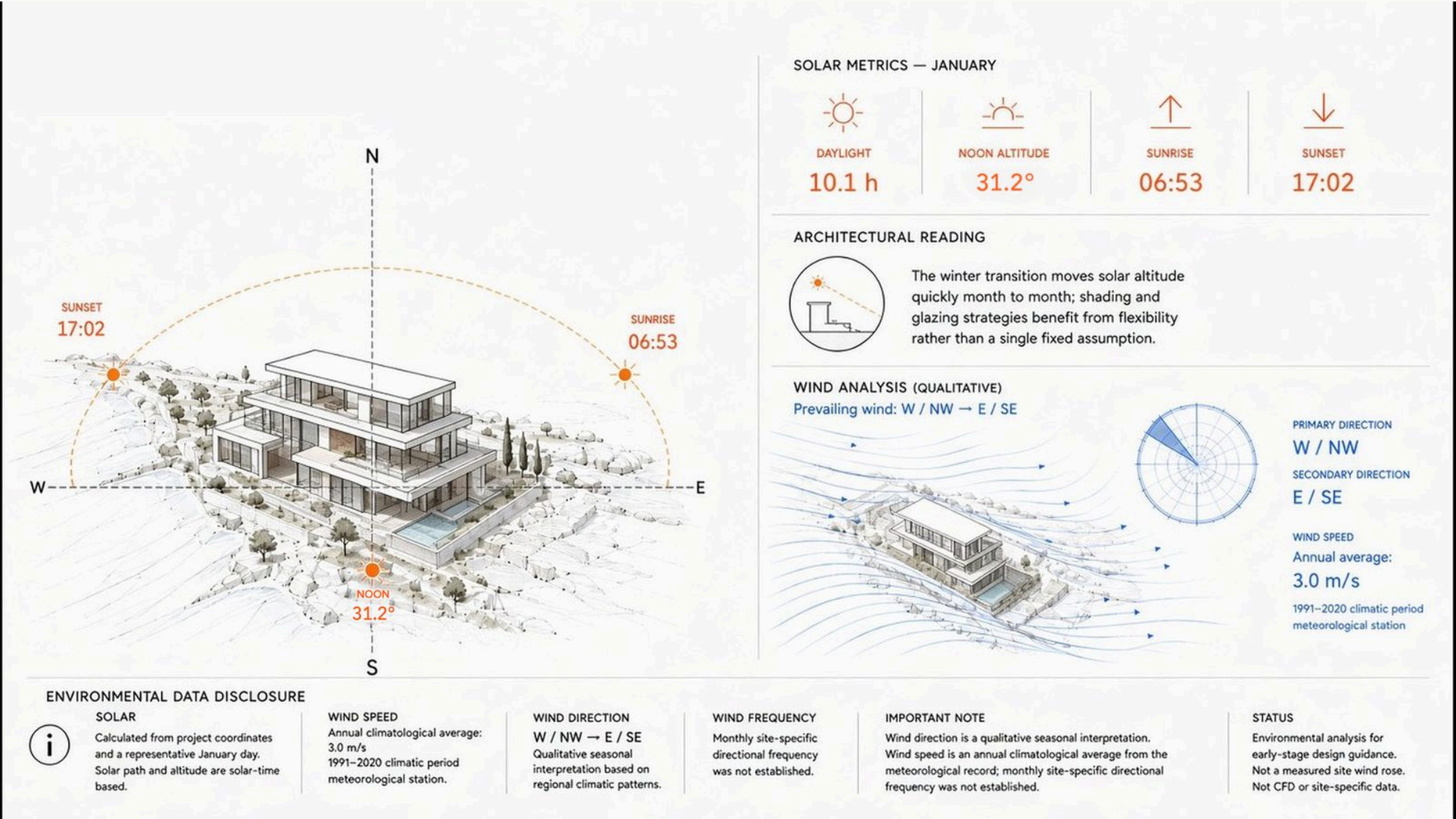
FINAL ARCHITECTURE — SECTIONS



Section A-A — illustrated.



Section B-B — illustrated.



VISUALIZATION



Exterior — View 03



Exterior — View 02



Interior — Poolside



Interior — Living Room



Interior — Master Bedroom

Villa Efe is a new-construction villa on a sloping seafront site, organised vertically across four levels — basement, ground floor, first floor and roof terrace. The slope itself was never a problem for me. I genuinely love working with level differences; they give me freedom in design rather than take it away. The real starting challenge was different: the floor areas were large, and the owner had a strong desire for light-filled spaces throughout the house, including spaces that a large footprint naturally pushes away from the perimeter.

To bring daylight deep into the plan I repeatedly had to reposition and enlarge a central light well. Under normal circumstances that alone would have lit every room properly. It became genuinely difficult when the owner also wanted the basement entertainment room to receive natural light. Directly above that room, on the ground floor, sat a terrarium-like green space that took its own light from the central entrance. I wanted to keep this terrarium as the green heart of the house rather than sacrifice it to solve the basement's lighting. The solution was to design part of the living space in the middle of the terrarium in glass, so light could pass straight through it down to the basement. Getting that detail right meant designing and presenting the insulation and technical build-up myself, by hand, so the glazed floor would actually perform and not merely look correct in section.

The hardest part of the project came from the site's position. The front façade faces the sea and the house sits at zero distance from the shore. The owner wanted to use every possible square metre that position offered, including a large infinity pool. The size of the pool left almost no circulation or seating space around it and the house. My response was a movable deck that could extend out over the pool water, creating usable outdoor space on demand without permanently giving up the pool itself. That tension — maximising water against maximising usable space at zero distance from the shore — shaped the design more than the slope ever did.

If I were to start Villa Efe again, I would likely focus earlier on coordinating the project's different demands together, rather than solving each one separately. What this project made clear to me is that an architectural decision is rarely just a spatial one — it immediately affects structure, light, insulation, how the space is used, and even the exterior. What mattered most to me was realizing that solving a problem doesn't have to mean giving up on a good architectural idea. That's exactly what happened with the terrarium, the basement light, and the infinity pool: instead of dropping one of the requirements, I looked for a way to let all of them coexist, even if it meant working out more technical detail myself. The most important lesson I took from Villa Efe was this: sometimes the best solution isn't a compromise — it's finding a way you don't have to compromise at all.